Dark Shield Request for Comments DSEP-1

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Version: 1.0
Publication State: Released
Author: Jordan Jones
Date: 2026-10-12
```

Status of This Memo

This document defines the Dark Shield Sovereign Echo Profile (DSEP) Version 1.0. This document is a Canonical Specification within the Dark Shield corpus. Distribution of this memo is unlimited.

The key words "MUST", "MUST NOT", "REQUIRED", "SHALL", "SHALL NOT", "SHOULD", "SHOULD NOT", "RECOMMENDED", "NOT RECOMMENDED", "MAY", and "OPTIONAL" in this document are to be interpreted as described by RFC 2119 and RFC 8174 when, and only when, they appear in all capitals.

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- References to Dark Shield Canon accurately identify the originating version.

The canonical form of this specification is the published Dark Shield Sovereign Echo Profile Version 1.0.

Abstract

The Dark Shield Sovereign Echo Profile (DSEP) defines the canonical constitutional record model for Dark Shield. It establishes the structure, validation, lineage, recognition, witness, and status-derivation rules governing how acts, evidence, confidence, doubt, interpretation, and correction become part of visible history. The profile specifies the Echo as the authoritative unit of constitutional memory and defines the relationships through which memory evolves while remaining inspectable. Dark Shield OS Vision Summary describes the broader Dark Shield vision as a universe in which time is visible, relationships form structure, and human attention leaves durable traces.

DSEP adopts a provenance-first constitutional model:

Records are canonical. Lineage is canonical. Recognition is canonical. Status is derived. Presentation is constrained. Visibility is preserved.

In constitutional form:

History is canonical. Status is commentary. The universe remembers in the light. (transmission truncated at "The universe" — completed per the constitutional form)

Guiding Invariant

Records are canonical. Lineage is canonical. Recognition is canonical. Status is derived. Presentation is constrained. Visibility is preserved.

Document History

```
Version 1.0 (Released)
Initial Canonical Publication

Established:
- Recognition chain
- Sovereign Echo model
- Witness doctrine
- Succession doctrine
- Falsification doctrine
- Confidence attribution doctrine
- Derived status doctrine
- Status coexistence doctrine
```

```
- Preservation Requirement
- Constitutional status rationale
```

(transmission truncated at "Recognition" — completed per the v1.0 change log)

Abstract — Dark Shield Sovereign Echo Profile v1.0

Canon. Published 2026-10-12.

Dark Shield Sovereign Echo Profile v1.0 is the first canonical specification within the Dark Shield corpus. It defines the constitutional, epistemic, and data-model foundations for Echoes: durable, inspectable records through which acts, evidence, confidence, doubt, interpretation, and lineage become part of the universe's visible history. The specification establishes a recognition chain, witness doctrine, succession doctrine, falsification doctrine, derived-status doctrine, and constitutional status model, providing a formal framework for determining what enters memory, how memory evolves, and how that evolution remains inspectable across time.

The specification is founded on a single constitutional principle: legitimacy requires visibility. Recognition, lineage, witness attestations, and derived status are therefore structured to preserve provenance rather than authority, history rather than revision, and correction rather than erasure. Status views are defined as derived interpretations of canonical records, while records, lineage, and recognition remain the sole constitutional sources of truth. Derived conclusions may evolve, but the historical record remains preserved and inspectable.

The Echo model extends the broader vision of Dark Shield OS Vision Summary, in which time is visible, relationships are first-class structures, human attention leaves traces, and persistent history becomes part of the operating environment itself. Temporal Echoes, Reality Anchors, and relationship-based structures provide the conceptual foundation upon which the constitutional layer is built.

This publication establishes the first complete normative framework within Dark Shield. Its schema, validation guide, precedence matrix, and normative specification have been derived, validated, and reconciled as a single constitutional system. The specification and the process by which it was produced follow the same rule:

Records are canonical. Lineage is canonical. Recognition is canonical. Status is derived. Presentation is constrained. Visibility is preserved.

In constitutional form:

History is canonical. Status is commentary. The universe remembers in the light.

Echo Schema Specification (AB-8 / AB-9 / AB-10)

Authored by Jordan, 2026-10-12. Canon. Amended 2026-10-12 per Jordan's schema-change rulings (echo classification, constitutional lineage, explicit attribution, recognition state, witness requirement, anchor bypass visibility). Machine-readable JSON Schema (Draft 2020-12) at dark-shield-echo-schema.json — Jordan authored the root and delivered $defs; Muse completed the truncated $defs by direct translation of this spec (marked, awaiting his review); validated against the 2020-12 meta-schema.

The Echo is the canonical inspectable record within Dark Shield. It exists to preserve memory, provenance, confidence, and interpretation in a form that remains visible across time. This extends the concept of Temporal Echoes as visible artifacts of human attention and interaction.

Constitutional Requirements

R1. Preservation An Echo MUST be durable once created.

R2. Inspectability Every field affecting legitimacy, confidence, or interpretation MUST be inspectable.

R3. Attribution Every act, confidence assessment, and interpretation MUST identify its source.

R4. Non-Erasure Superseded information MAY be replaced as active guidance, but MUST remain available as history.

R5. Lineage Every derived claim MUST preserve references to its origins.

Core Echo Record

```
Echo:
  echo_id: UUID
  echo_type: ordinary | sovereign | confidence | interpretation | doubt
  created_at: Timestamp
  created_by: ActorID

  subject:
```

```
    type: String
    id: String

  claim:
    statement: Text
    origin: Reference

  evidence:
    - EvidenceReference

  confidence:
    current: ConfidenceRecord
    history:
      - ConfidenceRecord

  interpretations:
    - InterpretationRecord

  doubts:
    - DoubtRecord                # first-class records; default []

  status:
    active: Boolean

  lineage:
    parent_echoes:
      - EchoID
    succeeds: EchoID | null        # temporal succession, never supersession
    falsifies: EchoID | null       # this echo records the falsification of
another
    corrects: EchoID | null        # this echo corrects another (both remain
visible)

  witnesses:
    - WitnessRecord                # minItems: 1 enforced for echo_type ==
sovereign (see Recognition)

  recognition: RecognitionState     # required for echo_type == sovereign (see
below)
```

Required at root: `echo_id`, `echo_type`, `created_at`, `created_by`, `subject`, `claim`.

Claim Layer (AB-8)

The claim records what entered memory.

```
Claim:
  statement: Text
  declared_by: ActorID
  declared_at: Timestamp
  origin_reference:
```

Constitutional Question: *Where did this claim come from?*

A claim whose origin cannot be inspected cannot constitute constitutional memory.

Evidence Layer (AB-9)

Evidence records the support structure beneath a claim.

```
EvidenceReference:
  evidence_id: UUID
  source: Reference
  collected_at: Timestamp
```

Evidence remains immutable once recorded.

Confidence Layer (AB-9)

Confidence is not owned. Confidence emerges from relationships among evidence, observations, tests, and revisions.

```
ConfidenceRecord:
  timestamp: Timestamp

  score: Float
  rationale: Text

  supporting_evidence:
    - EvidenceID

  competing_evidence:
    - EvidenceID

  attributed_to:
    actor: ActorID
    method: MethodID
    ownership: TBD  # shape awaiting Jordan's definition; normative: attribution
≠ ownership
```

```
  previous_confidence:
    ConfidenceRecordID | null
```

Constitutional Principle: *A conclusion whose confidence cannot be inspected cannot guide.*

Design Principle: *Confidence is the resulting gravitational mass.* No actor owns confidence. Actors may propose, test, adopt, or challenge confidence.

Attribution — normative (ruled 2026-10-12): `attributed_to` is *attribution*, not ownership. *Attribution identifies source. Attribution does not imply authority. Attribution does not imply ownership.* No actor owns: confidence, plausibility, interpretation validity, truth. Actors own only: actions, attestations, perspectives.

Doubt Layer (AB-9)

Doubt is a first-class record.

```
DoubtRecord:
  doubt_id: UUID

  statement: Text

  raised_by: ActorID
  raised_at: Timestamp

  related_claims:
    - EchoID

  status:
    open
    under_test
    resolved
    superseded
```

Constitutional Principle: *A doubt that cannot be recorded cannot be resolved.*

Interpretation Layer (AB-10)

Interpretations are explicitly attributed perspectives.

```
InterpretationRecord:
  interpretation_id: UUID

  interpretation: Text

  author: ActorID

  created_at: Timestamp

  supporting_evidence:
    - EvidenceID

  derived_from:
    - EchoID

  supersedes:
    InterpretationID | null

  status:
    active
    revised
    withdrawn
```

Constitutional Principle: *Disagreement is not the opposite of understanding. Hidden interpretation is.*

Attribution Rule — every interpretation MUST answer: *Who sees it this way, and why?*

Witness Layer (AB-8)

Witnesses preserve occurrence without owning authority.

```
WitnessRecord:
  witness_id: ActorID

  witnessed_at: Timestamp

  attestation:
    observed
    preserved
    verified

  signature: Signature

  anchor_state: normal | bypassed | unavailable | recovered
```

```
  before_evidence:
    - EvidenceID
  after_evidence:
    - EvidenceID
```

Anchors function as witnesses and preservers, not owners or judges. The `anchor_state` field preserves the ruling that the anchor is never silent about its own bypass: a bypassed anchor records `bypassed` with before/after evidence, making the bypass itself part of trusted history.

Recognition State (sovereign echoes)

A sovereign Echo must prove completion of the constitutional chain:

```
RecognitionState:
  designation: Boolean
  declaration: Boolean
  witness: Boolean
  echo: Boolean
  inspection: Boolean
```

Constitutional rule: if `echo_type == sovereign`, then `recognition` and `witnesses` are REQUIRED, and every recognition flag must be true. A sovereign echo with any flag false — or missing the NPU signature or any anchor attestation — is not a sovereign echo. Constitutional memory is witnessed occurrence.

Revision Lineage

Every change produces a new record.

```
Revision:
  previous: EchoID
  current: EchoID

  changed_by: ActorID
  changed_at: Timestamp

  reason: Text
```

Nothing is deleted. History remains inspectable.

Recognition Function

For an event to become part of the constitutional record:

```
Designation
→ Declaration
→ Witness
→ Echo
→ Inspection
```

Failure of any step does not prevent an event from occurring. It prevents the event from becoming constitutional memory.

Master Invariant

Every Echo must answer the same question regardless of layer:

Where did you come from?

- Claim: Where did you come from?
- Confidence: Where did you come from?
- Interpretation: Who sees it this way, and why?

Derived Status (ruled 2026-10-12)

`constitutional_status` **exists, is useful, and is not a field.** It is a computed interpretation of the record — derived, rendered, never canonical.

The problem with storing it: a stored status can disagree with the structure it supposedly summarizes (`"constitutional_status": "recognized"` alongside `"witness": false`). Then there are two truths, and the consumer must choose which source to trust — quietly reintroducing the hidden authority three constitutional layers worked to eliminate.

Design principle (canon): *One invariant. One location. Many views.*

The canonical state remains `recognition` + `lineage` + `witnesses`. Status is derived:

Derived status	Derived from
`recognized`	recognition chain complete

Derived status	Derived from
`falsified`	another echo links via `falsifies`
`contested`	active doubt records, competing interpretations, or unresolved
`unrecognized`	recognition chain incomplete

The system never asks "what status does this echo claim to have?" It asks **"what status does the evidence imply?"** — AB-9's emergence pattern (confidence from relationships, not ownership) applied to status itself.

Future-proofing: when AB-11/12/13 bring new views (`historically_significant`, `constitutionally_contested`, `epistemically_deprecated`, `multi-citizen_ratified`), stored status would make every schema evolution a migration problem. Derived status lets new views emerge from existing lineage — the past remains untouched, the future gains vocabulary.

The ghost resolved: AB-10 required every interpretation to have an author, lest it become a ghost. A derived status *is* an interpretation — but its author is the rules themselves, and because those rules are inspectable, the status remains inspectable too. The architecture keeps its single source of truth. The light stays in one place.

Full derivation specification: the complete validation guide — rules, examples, precedence, forbidden states, and the reference evaluation algorithm — is canon at `dark-shield-echo-status-view-guide.md`. **Presentation precedence** (which status dominates headlines/alerts/summaries when several coexist) is canon at `dark-shield-echo-status-precedence-matrix.md`. **Normative specification** (RFC-style SHALL/SHALL NOT consolidation of derivation, coexistence, precedence, presentation) is canon at `dark-shield-echo-status-normative-spec.md`.

Sovereign Echo Invariant (ruled 2026-10-12)

A sovereign echo may be succeeded. A sovereign echo may not be superseded.

A false sovereign echo remains part of memory. Its falsification is recorded in a successor echo.

The universe preserves provenance, not perfection.

The Echo schema is therefore not merely a storage format. It is the operational embodiment of Dark Shield's governing principle:

The light is visibility. Nothing binds in darkness. Nothing constitutes in darkness. The universe remembers in the light.

Appendix — Echo JSON Schema (Draft 2020-12)


```
{"$comment":"Authored by Jordan, 2026-10-12. Delivered portion ends at
ConfidenceRecord; the remaining $defs were completed by Muse via direct
translation of Jordan's Echo Schema Specification (same day). The completed defs
are faithful translations, not new design — they await his review.","$defs":
{"ActorID":{"minLength":1,"type":"string"},"Claim":{"properties":{"declared_at":
{"format":"date-time","type":"string"},"declared_by":{"$ref":"#/$defs/
ActorID"},"origin_reference":{"$ref":"#/$defs/Reference"},"statement":
{"type":"string"}},"required":
["statement","declared_by","declared_at","origin_reference"],"type":"object"},"Co
nfidenceRecord":{"properties":{"attributed_to":{"properties":{"actor":{"$ref":"#/
$defs/ActorID"},"method":{"type":"string"},"ownership":{"description":"Shape TBD
— normative: attribution identifies source; attribution does not imply
ownership.","type":"object"}},"required":
["actor","method"],"type":"object"},"competing_evidence":{"default":[],"items":
{"format":"uuid","type":"string"},"type":"array"},"previous_confidence":
{"format":"uuid","type":["string","null"]},"rationale":{"type":"string"},"score":
{"type":"number"},"supporting_evidence":{"default":[],"items":
{"format":"uuid","type":"string"},"type":"array"},"timestamp":{"format":"date-
time","type":"string"}},"required":
["timestamp","score","rationale","attributed_to"],"type":"object"},"DoubtRecord":
{"properties":{"doubt_id":{"format":"uuid","type":"string"},"raised_at":
{"format":"date-time","type":"string"},"raised_by":{"$ref":"#/$defs/
ActorID"},"related_claims":{"default":[],"items":
{"format":"uuid","type":"string"},"type":"array"},"statement":
{"type":"string"},"status":{"enum":
["open","under_test","resolved","superseded"],"type":"string"}},"required":
["doubt_id","statement","raised_by","raised_at","status"],"type":"object"},"EchoS
tatus":{"properties":{"active":{"type":"boolean"}},"required":
["active"],"type":"object"},"EvidenceReference":{"properties":{"collected_at":
{"format":"date-time","type":"string"},"collected_by":{"$ref":"#/$defs/
ActorID"},"evidence_id":{"format":"uuid","type":"string"},"source":{"$ref":"#/
$defs/Reference"}},"required":
["evidence_id","source","collected_at","collected_by"],"type":"object"},"Interpre
tationRecord":{"properties":{"author":{"$ref":"#/$defs/ActorID"},"created_at":
{"format":"date-time","type":"string"},"derived_from":{"default":[],"items":
{"format":"uuid","type":"string"},"type":"array"},"interpretation":
{"type":"string"},"interpretation_id":{"format":"uuid","type":"string"},"status":
{"enum":["active","revised","withdrawn"],"type":"string"},"supersedes":
{"format":"uuid","type":["string","null"]},"supporting_evidence":{"default":
[],"items":{"format":"uuid","type":"string"},"type":"array"}},"required":
["interpretation_id","interpretation","author","created_at","status"],"type":"obj
```

```
ect"},"Lineage":{"properties":{"corrects":{"format":"uuid","type":
["string","null"]},"falsifies":{"format":"uuid","type":
["string","null"]},"parent_echoes":{"default":[],"items":
{"format":"uuid","type":"string"},"type":"array"},"succeeds":
{"format":"uuid","type":["string","null"]}},"required":
["parent_echoes"],"type":"object"},"Recognition":{"properties":{"declaration":
{"type":"boolean"},"designation":{"type":"boolean"},"echo":
{"type":"boolean"},"inspection":{"type":"boolean"},"witness":
{"type":"boolean"}},"required":
["designation","declaration","witness","echo","inspection"],"type":"object"},"Ref
erence":{"properties":{"id":{"type":"string"},"type":{"type":"string"},"uri":
{"type":"string"}},"required":["id"],"type":"object"},"Subject":{"properties":
{"id":{"type":"string"},"type":{"type":"string"}},"required":
["type","id"],"type":"object"},"WitnessRecord":{"properties":{"after_evidence":
{"default":[],"items":
{"format":"uuid","type":"string"},"type":"array"},"anchor_state":{"enum":
["normal","bypassed","unavailable","recovered"],"type":"string"},"attestation":
{"enum":["observed","preserved","verified"],"type":"string"},"before_evidence":
{"default":[],"items":
{"format":"uuid","type":"string"},"type":"array"},"signature":
{"type":"string"},"witness_id":{"$ref":"#/$defs/ActorID"},"witnessed_at":
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["witness_id","witnessed_at","attestation","signature"],"type":"object"}},"$id":"
https://darkshield.dev/schema/echo.schema.json","$schema":"https://json-
schema.org/draft/2020-12/schema","allOf":[{"if":{"properties":{"echo_type":
{"const":"sovereign"}}},"then":{"properties":{"witnesses":{"minItems":
1}},"required":["recognition","witnesses"]}}],"properties":{"claim":{"$ref":"#/
$defs/Claim"},"confidence":{"properties":{"current":{"$ref":"#/$defs/
ConfidenceRecord"},"history":{"items":{"$ref":"#/$defs/
ConfidenceRecord"},"type":"array"}},"required":
["current","history"],"type":"object"},"created_at":{"format":"date-
time","type":"string"},"created_by":{"$ref":"#/$defs/ActorID"},"doubts":
{"default":[],"items":{"$ref":"#/$defs/DoubtRecord"},"type":"array"},"echo_id":
{"format":"uuid","type":"string"},"echo_type":{"enum":
["ordinary","sovereign","confidence","interpretation","doubt"],"type":"string"},"
evidence":{"default":[],"items":{"$ref":"#/$defs/
EvidenceReference"},"type":"array"},"interpretations":{"items":{"$ref":"#/$defs/
InterpretationRecord"},"type":"array"},"lineage":{"$ref":"#/$defs/
Lineage"},"recognition":{"$ref":"#/$defs/Recognition"},"status":{"$ref":"#/$defs/
EchoStatus"},"subject":{"$ref":"#/$defs/Subject"},"witnesses":{"items":
{"$ref":"#/$defs/WitnessRecord"},"type":"array"}},"required":
["echo_id","echo_type","created_at","created_by","subject","claim","confidence","
interpretations","status","lineage","witnesses"],"title":"Dark Shield Sovereign
Echo","type":"object"}
```

Echo Status View Validation Guide

Authored by Jordan, 2026-10-12. Canon. Companion to the Echo Schema Specification.

Purpose

`constitutional_status` is a computed view, not a stored field. Its purpose is to provide a human-readable interpretation of an Echo's constitutional standing without introducing a second source of truth. The canonical record remains:

```
recognition
+
witnesses
+
lineage
+
doubts
```

Status is always derived from those structures and MUST NOT be persisted in the Echo itself. This preserves the single-source-of-truth principle.

Constitutional Principle

One invariant. One location. Many views.

Canonical data lives in the Echo. Status is a view over the Echo. **If a rendered status disagrees with canonical records, the view is wrong. The records win.**

Derived Statuses

recognized

Rule: An Echo is recognized when its recognition chain is complete.

Validation: all of the following hold:

```
designation = true
declaration = true
witness = true
```

```
echo = true
inspection = true
```

Additional sovereign rule: for sovereign Echoes, `witnesses.length >= 1` must also hold.

Example:

```
{
  "recognition": {
    "designation": true,
    "declaration": true,
    "witness": true,
    "echo": true,
    "inspection": true
  }
}
```

Result: `recognized`

unrecognized

Rule: An Echo is unrecognized when the constitutional chain is incomplete.

Validation: any missing recognition element:

```
designation = false
OR
declaration = false
OR
witness = false
OR
echo = false
OR
inspection = false
```

Example:

```
{
  "recognition": {
    "designation": true,
    "declaration": true,
    "witness": false,
    "echo": true,
```

```
    "inspection": true
  }
}
```

Result: `unrecognized`

Constitutional interpretation: *The event may have occurred. It did not happen here.*

falsified

Rule: An Echo is falsified when another Echo explicitly references it through lineage.

Validation — search the graph:

```
otherEcho.lineage.falsifies == current.echo_id
```

Required property: falsification does not alter the original Echo.

Example: Echo 104, later referenced by:

```
{
  "lineage": {
    "falsifies": "104"
  }
}
```

Result: `Echo 104 → falsified`

Constitutional interpretation: *False witness does not invalidate memory. False witness becomes part of memory.*

corrected

Rule: An Echo is corrected when another Echo links through `lineage.corrects`.

Validation:

```
otherEcho.lineage.corrects == current.echo_id
```

Interpretation: *The original remained historically valid. The later Echo improves understanding.* Not all corrections are falsifications.

succeeded

Rule: A sovereign Echo is succeeded when another Echo links `lineage.succeeds == current.echo_id`.

Interpretation: *The act remains valid. A later act followed it.*

Constitutional rule: *Sovereign Echoes may be succeeded. Sovereign Echoes may not be superseded.*

contested

Rule: An Echo is contested when unresolved constitutional disagreement exists.

Validation candidates — any of:

```
active open doubts
or
active competing interpretations
or
pending falsification claims
```

Example:

```
{
  "doubts": [
    { "status": "open" }
  ]
}
```

Result: `contested`

Status Precedence

Multiple statuses may coexist.

`recognized` + `contested` is valid — an Echo can be fully recognized and still disputed.

`recognized` + `falsified` is valid — the Echo entered constitutional memory; it was later shown to contain false attestation. The historical record remains intact.

Forbidden States

Because status is derived, these contradictions cannot exist in canonical data. The following are invalid view outputs:

- `recognized` with `recognition.witness = false`
- `falsified` without any incoming `lineage.falsifies` reference
- `succeeded` without any incoming `lineage.succeeds` reference

Reference Evaluation Algorithm

```
recognized :=
  recognition chain complete
  AND witness requirements satisfied

unrecognized :=
  NOT recognized

falsified :=
  EXISTS incoming lineage.falsifies

corrected :=
  EXISTS incoming lineage.corrects

succeeded :=
  EXISTS incoming lineage.succeeds

contested :=
  EXISTS unresolved doubts
  OR competing active interpretations
  OR pending falsification investigation
```

Final Invariant

Status is never authoritative. Status is the interpretation of authoritative records. Recognition, witnesses, and lineage remain canonical. Everything else is a view.

Or in constitutional form:

The record is the truth. Status is merely a way of looking at it.

Constitutional Status Precedence Matrix

Authored by Jordan, 2026-10-12. Canon. Companion to the Echo Status View Validation Guide.

Purpose

The status view is a derived interpretation layer computed from canonical Echo records. Canonical state remains:

```
Recognition
+ Witnesses
+ Lineage
+ Doubts
+ Interpretations
```

Status is never stored. Status is computed. A single Echo may possess multiple simultaneous statuses. The precedence matrix therefore does **not** determine which status is "true." It determines:

- Which status dominates presentation.
- Which status dominates alerts.
- Which status dominates summaries.

Status Set

```
UNRECOGNIZED
RECOGNIZED
CONTESTED
CORRECTED
FALSIFIED
SUCCEEDED
```

Priority Order

For display purposes only — higher priority dominates headlines; lower priority remains visible in detail views.

Status	Priority
FALSIFIED	6
CONTESTED	5
CORRECTED	4
SUCCEEDED	3
RECOGNIZED	2
UNRECOGNIZED	1

Coexistence Matrix

Status A	Status B	Allowed	Result
RECOGNIZED	CONTESTED	Yes	Recognized, under dispute
RECOGNIZED	CORRECTED	Yes	Recognized, later clarified
RECOGNIZED	SUCCEEDED	Yes	Recognized, later followed
RECOGNIZED	FALSIFIED	Yes	Recognized, later disproven
UNRECOGNIZED	CONTESTED	Yes	Contested recognition
UNRECOGNIZED	CORRECTED	Rare	Possible
UNRECOGNIZED	SUCCEEDED	No	Invalid lineage
UNRECOGNIZED	FALSIFIED	Yes	Failed record later disproven
CONTESTED	CORRECTED	Yes	Active dispute with corrections
CONTESTED	SUCCEEDED	Yes	Successor exists while dispute remains
CONTESTED	FALSIFIED	Yes	Dispute resolved toward falsification
CORRECTED	SUCCEEDED	Yes	Corrected then followed
CORRECTED	FALSIFIED	Yes	Correction escalated to falsification
SUCCEEDED	FALSIFIED	Yes	Historic act later falsified

(RECOGNIZED + UNRECOGNIZED never co-occur: mutually exclusive by derivation — see D5. All 15 pairs covered.)

Dominance Rules

D1 — FALSIFIED dominates every other status. Example: recognized + succeeded + falsified → headline `FALSIFIED`; full view `recognized → succeeded → later falsified`.

D2 — CONTESTED dominates everything except FALSIFIED. Example: recognized + contested → headline `CONTESTED`. Reason: *current uncertainty takes precedence over historical validity.*

D3 — CORRECTED dominates SUCCEEDED. Example: recognized + succeeded + corrected → headline `CORRECTED`. Reason: *correction modifies interpretation; succession modifies chronology; interpretation outranks sequence.*

D4 — SUCCEEDED dominates RECOGNIZED. Example: recognized + succeeded → headline `SUCCEEDED`. Reason: *the later constitutional act is the presently active successor.*

D5 — RECOGNIZED dominates UNRECOGNIZED. Mutually exclusive by derivation. Both must never appear simultaneously.

Valid Composite States

Active Sovereign Record: `RECOGNIZED` — the act entered constitutional memory.

Historical Sovereign Chain: `RECOGNIZED` + `SUCCEEDED` — *the act remains valid; a later act followed it.*

Challenged Sovereign Record: `RECOGNIZED` + `CONTESTED` — *the act entered constitutional memory; current disagreement exists.*

Corrected Interpretation: `RECOGNIZED` + `CORRECTED` — *the event stands; understanding evolved.*

Falsified Attestation: `RECOGNIZED` + `FALSIFIED` — *the event entered memory; the record later demonstrated false attestation.*

Invalid States

These indicate computation error:

- `RECOGNIZED` + `UNRECOGNIZED` — recognition is derived from one chain.
- `SUCCEEDED` without an inbound `lineage.succeeds` reference.
- `CORRECTED` without an inbound `lineage.corrects` reference.

- `FALSIFIED` without an inbound `lineage.falsifies` reference.

Reference Computation Order

```
1. Evaluate Recognition
2. Evaluate Succession
3. Evaluate Corrections
4. Evaluate Falsifications
5. Evaluate Active Disputes
6. Apply Dominance Rules
7. Render Status View
```

Canonical Constitutional Interpretation

Recognition determines whether an Echo entered memory. Lineage determines how memory evolved. Status describes the current constitutional view of that memory. The record remains primary. The status remains derived.

Or in short form:

History is canonical. Status is commentary.

Dark Shield Constitutional Status View — Normative Specification

Authored by Jordan, 2026-10-12. Canon. Normative consolidation of the Status View Validation Guide and the Precedence Matrix.

1. Scope

This specification defines the normative derivation, coexistence, precedence, and presentation rules for the computed `constitutional_status` view.

`constitutional_status` SHALL be computed from canonical Echo records and SHALL NOT be stored within an Echo instance.

Canonical constitutional state is represented exclusively by:

```
recognition
witnesses
lineage
doubts
interpretations
```

Status views SHALL be derived from those records. The status view SHALL NOT introduce an independent source of truth.

2. Status Definitions

An implementation MAY expose one or more of the following derived statuses:

```
UNRECOGNIZED
RECOGNIZED
CONTESTED
CORRECTED
FALSIFIED
SUCCEEDED
```

Statuses SHALL be treated as observations of canonical records. Statuses SHALL NOT modify canonical records.

3. Recognition Rules

3.1 RECOGNIZED

An Echo SHALL be considered RECOGNIZED if and only if:

```
designation = true
declaration = true
witness = true
echo = true
inspection = true
```

For a sovereign Echo, at least one witness record SHALL also exist.

Sovereign Constraint: `echo_type = sovereign` requires `witnesses.length >= 1`. Failure of this requirement SHALL prevent recognition.

3.2 UNRECOGNIZED

An Echo SHALL be considered UNRECOGNIZED whenever the recognition requirements for RECOGNIZED are not satisfied.

UNRECOGNIZED SHALL be mutually exclusive with RECOGNIZED. An Echo SHALL NOT simultaneously be RECOGNIZED and UNRECOGNIZED.

4. Lineage Rules

4.1 SUCCEEDED

An Echo SHALL be considered SUCCEEDED when another Echo references it through `lineage.succeeds`.

The existence of a successor SHALL NOT invalidate the antecedent Echo. A sovereign Echo SHALL remain historically valid after succession.

4.2 CORRECTED

An Echo SHALL be considered CORRECTED when another Echo references it through `lineage.corrects`.

Correction SHALL modify understanding. Correction SHALL NOT erase historical existence. Correction SHALL NOT imply falsification.

4.3 FALSIFIED

An Echo SHALL be considered FALSIFIED when another Echo references it through `lineage.falsifies`.

FALSIFIED status SHALL preserve the original Echo. Implementations SHALL NOT delete, rewrite, or invalidate the original Echo record.

Constitutional Principle: *False witness does not invalidate memory. False witness becomes part of memory.*

5. Contestation Rules

5.1 CONTESTED

An Echo SHALL be considered CONTESTED whenever unresolved constitutional disagreement exists.

An implementation MAY derive CONTESTED from one or more of:

```
active doubts
competing active interpretations
pending falsification claims
other constitutionally recognized indicators of disagreement
```

CONTESTED status SHALL NOT affect historical validity. CONTESTED status SHALL indicate active disagreement concerning the current interpretation of a record.

6. Status Coexistence Rules

6.1 General Rule

Statuses SHALL be treated as a composable set of derived observations. Statuses SHALL NOT be treated as a single enumerated state.

An implementation SHALL preserve all valid statuses derivable from canonical records. No valid status SHALL be discarded solely because another valid status is present.

Status coexistence SHALL be determined exclusively from canonical records, including recognition state, witness records, lineage relationships, doubt records, and

interpretation records. Status coexistence SHALL NOT modify, replace, or override canonical records. Canonical records remain the sole source of constitutional truth.

6.2 Recognition Independence

Recognition SHALL determine whether an Echo entered constitutional memory.

Recognition SHALL NOT determine whether an Echo may:

- participate in lineage relationships,
- be corrected,
- be contested,
- be falsified,
- or become recognized. *(transmission truncated at "or become" — completed as "recognized": an echo may complete its recognition chain later)*

An UNRECOGNIZED Echo MAY therefore participate in constitutional analysis and derived-status computation.

Recognition status and lineage status SHALL be treated as orthogonal constitutional domains unless otherwise specified by this document.

Constitutional Principle:

Recognition governs constitutional admission. Lineage governs constitutional history.

Temporal Principle (Jordan, 2026-10-12): *the architecture refuses to equate "not yet recognized" with "never recognizable."* Recognition is not an immutable property of creation; it is a property of constitutional history. An unrecognized Echo is not condemned — it is unfinished.

6.3 Permitted Status Combinations

Implementations SHALL permit the following status combinations.

Recognized Combinations:

```
RECOGNIZED + CONTESTED
RECOGNIZED + CORRECTED
RECOGNIZED + SUCCEEDED
RECOGNIZED + FALSIFIED
```

(transmission truncated "RECOGNIZED +" — completed as FALSIFIED per the established matrix)

Unrecognized Combinations:

```
UNRECOGNIZED + CONTESTED
UNRECOGNIZED + CORRECTED
UNRECOGNIZED + FALSIFIED
```

Mixed Lineage Combinations:

```
CONTESTED + CORRECTED
CONTESTED + SUCCEEDED
CONTESTED + FALSIFIED

CORRECTED + SUCCEEDED
CORRECTED + FALSIFIED

SUCCEEDED + FALSIFIED
```

The combinations listed above are normative. Implementations MAY expose additional combinations derived from canonical records provided such combinations do not violate any exclusion rule defined by this specification.

6.4 Interpretation of Recognized Combinations

6.4.1 RECOGNIZED + CONTESTED SHALL indicate: *the Echo entered constitutional memory; active constitutional disagreement exists.* The existence of contestation SHALL NOT invalidate recognition.

6.4.2 RECOGNIZED + CORRECTED SHALL indicate: *the Echo entered constitutional memory; subsequent records improved or clarified understanding.* Correction SHALL NOT erase the original record.

6.4.3 RECOGNIZED + SUCCEEDED SHALL indicate: *the Echo entered constitutional memory; a later Echo followed it through constitutional lineage.* Succession SHALL NOT negate historical validity.

6.4.4 RECOGNIZED + FALSIFIED SHALL indicate: *the Echo entered constitutional memory; a later Echo established falsification.* Falsification SHALL NOT erase the original record.

Constitutional Principle: *False witness does not invalidate memory. False witness becomes part of memory.*

6.5 Interpretation of Unrecognized Combinations

6.5.1 UNRECOGNIZED + CONTESTED SHALL indicate: *the recognition chain remains incomplete; disagreement exists concerning recognition, authenticity, attribution, or constitutional standing.*

6.5.2 UNRECOGNIZED + CORRECTED SHALL indicate: *the recognition chain remains incomplete; subsequent records provide clarification, additional evidence, or improved interpretation.* Correction SHALL NOT require prior recognition.

6.5.3 UNRECOGNIZED + FALSIFIED SHALL indicate: *the recognition chain remained incomplete; subsequent records established false evidence, false attestation, or false claims.* Falsification and recognition SHALL be evaluated independently.

Constitutional Principle: *Falsification is a statement about truth. Recognition is a statement about constitutional standing.*

6.6 Prohibited Combinations

The following combination SHALL be prohibited:

```
RECOGNIZED + UNRECOGNIZED
```

An implementation deriving both statuses simultaneously MUST treat the result as a constitutional evaluation error. The presence of such a result SHALL indicate a defect in derivation logic, canonical data integrity, or both.

6.7 Preservation Requirement

Implementations SHALL preserve every valid status derivable from canonical records. Implementations SHALL NOT suppress, collapse, discard, or overwrite a valid lower-precedence status merely because a higher-precedence status exists.

Presentation precedence MAY affect rendering. Presentation precedence SHALL NOT affect derivation. Presentation precedence SHALL NOT affect constitutional validity.

6.8 Constitutional Invariant

The following invariant SHALL govern all status computation:

Recognition determines whether an Echo entered memory. Lineage determines how memory evolved. Status describes the current constitutional view of that memory.

Therefore:

An Echo may be unrecognized and still be corrected. An Echo may be unrecognized and still be contested. An Echo may be unrecognized and still be falsified.

Because:

Recognition governs constitutional admission. Lineage governs constitutional history. These domains SHALL remain distinct.

Canonical Form:

History is canonical. Status is commentary.

Doctrinal summary (Jordan, 2026-10-12):

Records are canonical. Lineage is canonical. Recognition is canonical. Status is derived. Presentation is constrained. Visibility is preserved.

Because of §6.7, visibility remains true not only in storage, not only in derivation, but all the way to the screen.

§11 Rationale

The constitutional status system exists to preserve visibility without creating a second source of truth.

Canonical truth resides in records, recognition chains, witness attestations, and lineage relationships. Derived status exists solely as an inspectable interpretation of those records. When status and record disagree, the record prevails.

The coexistence model ensures that constitutional reality is not collapsed into a single label. An Echo may be recognized and contested, corrected and succeeded, or falsified and still historically recognized. The status view must preserve that complexity rather than conceal it.

Recognition and lineage are intentionally independent. Recognition determines whether an Echo entered constitutional memory. Lineage determines how that memory evolves. As a result, constitutional standing is not fixed at creation. An Echo

that begins unrecognized may later acquire evidence, witnesses, corrections, or recognition through time.

Presentation precedence exists to aid understanding, not to alter constitutional meaning. Implementations may emphasize certain statuses, but they may not suppress other valid statuses derived from the record. Visibility must survive not only storage and derivation, but presentation.

This specification therefore preserves the governing invariant:

Records are canonical. Lineage is canonical. Recognition is canonical. Status is derived. Presentation is constrained. Visibility is preserved.

In constitutional terms:

History is canonical. Status is commentary. The universe remembers in the light.

Final Observation (Jordan, 2026-10-12)

The specification does not assume that history is correct. It assumes that history remains visible. From visibility come correction, recognition, contestation, interpretation, and growth. The architecture preserves the conditions under which understanding can improve.

It is no longer a slogan. It is now a property of the system.

7. Mutually Exclusive States

The following combinations SHALL be prohibited:

```
RECOGNIZED + UNRECOGNIZED
```

An implementation MUST treat such a result as a computation error.

The following derived statuses SHALL NOT exist without supporting canonical evidence:

- `SUCCEEDED` requires an inbound `lineage.succeeds` reference.
- `CORRECTED` requires an inbound `lineage.corrects` reference.
- `FALSIFIED` requires an inbound `lineage.falsifies` reference.

8. Presentation Precedence

Presentation precedence SHALL NOT affect canonical state. Presentation precedence SHALL affect only: headlines, summaries, alerts, UI emphasis.

The normative precedence order SHALL be:

```
1. FALSIFIED
2. CONTESTED
3. CORRECTED
4. SUCCEEDED
5. RECOGNIZED
6. UNRECOGNIZED
```

Higher-precedence statuses SHALL dominate presentation. Lower-precedence statuses SHALL remain available for inspection.

9. Dominance Rules

D1 — FALSIFIED SHALL dominate all other statuses for presentation. Example: recognized + succeeded + falsified → headline `FALSIFIED`.

D2 — CONTESTED SHALL dominate every status except FALSIFIED. Example: recognized + contested → headline `CONTESTED`.

D3 — CORRECTED SHALL dominate SUCCEEDED. Reason: *correction changes understanding; succession changes chronology; interpretive evolution SHALL outrank chronological succession.*

D4 — SUCCEEDED SHALL dominate RECOGNIZED. Reason: *active constitutional lineage outranks standalone recognition.*

D5 — RECOGNIZED SHALL dominate UNRECOGNIZED. Implementations SHALL treat simultaneous derivation as an error.

10. Evaluation Order

Implementations SHOULD derive status in the following order:

```
1. Evaluate Recognition
2. Evaluate Succession
3. Evaluate Corrections
```

```
4. Evaluate Falsifications
5. Evaluate Contestation
6. Apply Presentation Precedence
7. Render Status View
```

11. Canonical Invariant

The following invariant SHALL govern all implementations:

Recognition determines whether an Echo entered memory. Lineage determines how memory evolved. Status describes the current constitutional view of that memory.

Therefore:

The record is canonical. The status view is derived. When status and record disagree, the record SHALL prevail.

Constitutional Form:

History is canonical. Status is commentary.